

SCHEDULED TASK PERSISTENCE — INCIDENT REPORT

Persistence has been received through Scheduled Tasks

Project	HOME SOC LAB
Scenario	Persistence Check
Status	Detection successfully validated
Test date	23 August 2026

Absolutely. For the **Persistence Activity** report, we can keep **exactly this structure and level of detail**. Here is the content in that format:

1. Executive Summary

Following successful RDP authentication and subsequent post-RDP activity on the Windows 11 SOC host, a scheduled task was created under the authenticated user context. Windows Security recorded **Event ID 4698 (A scheduled task was created)**, and Wazuh generated **Rule 60228 at Level 4**.

The task was configured with a **logon trigger** and a benign command that outputs a lab-specific test string. The evidence demonstrates a scheduled-task persistence scenario in the controlled Home SOC Lab. The supplied telemetry does not by itself establish malicious intent.

2. Lab Environment

Component	Role	Host-Only IP
Kali Linux	Attack simulation / RDP test source	192.168.56.105
Windows 11	Target / Windows Security telemetry source	192.168.56.106
Wazuh	SIEM / detection and alerting	Wazuh server in lab

Network safety: The lab uses a Host-Only adapter for the attack path between the VMs. The test was bounded to the Windows VM and was not directed at the user's host machine.

3. Attack / Lab Scenario

- Successful RDP session established.
- Authenticated user context: `WIN11\vbouser`.
- Post-RDP activity was performed on the Windows 11 SOC host.
- A scheduled task named `\SOC-Lab-persistence-Test` was created.
- The task was configured with a **logon trigger**.

- The task action was:

```
cmd.exe /c echo SOC-LAB-PERSISTENCE-TEST
```

- Windows Security recorded **Event ID 4698**.
- Wazuh generated **Rule 60228, Level 4**.

4. Timeline

Stage	Evidence	Result
Authentication	Windows Event ID 4624, Logon Type 10	Successful RDP observed
Post-RDP Activity	PowerShell / endpoint telemetry	Activity continued after authentication
Persistence Action	Windows Security Event ID 4698	Scheduled task created
Detection	Wazuh Rule 60228, Level 4	Scheduled task creation alert generated

5. Detection Evidence

Wazuh: Rule 60228; Level 4; **A scheduled task was created;** Agent `Win-11-SOC`.

Field	Observed Value
Windows Event ID	4698
Event	A scheduled task was created
Wazuh Rule ID	60228
Wazuh Level	4
Task Name	\SOC-Lab-persistence-Test
Subject User	vboxuser
Subject Domain	WIN11
Subject Logon ID	0x2f33d
Task Author	WIN11\vboxuser
Trigger	LogonTrigger
Trigger Enabled	true

Field	Observed Value
Command	cmd.exe
Arguments	/c echo SOC-LAB-PERSISTENCE-TEST
Logon Type	InteractiveToken
Run Level	LeastPrivilege
Hidden	false
Task Enabled	true
Client Process ID	6376
Parent Process ID	3580
Event System Time	2026-08-23T18:14:53.7714067Z
Wazuh Alert Timestamp	2026-08-23T18:14:58.857Z

6. Technical Analysis

Windows Security **Event ID 4698** confirms that the scheduled task was created successfully. The task was authored by `WIN11\ vboxuser` and configured to trigger when the user logs on.

The configured action was:

```
cmd.exe /c echo SOC-LAB-PERSISTENCE-TEST
```

This command is benign and was used for the controlled lab simulation.

The task was **not hidden** and was configured with:

```
RunLevel = LeastPrivilege
```

Therefore, although Wazuh's MITRE mapping includes **Privilege Escalation** as an associated tactic, the supplied evidence does **not** demonstrate privilege escalation by this specific task.

The observed configuration demonstrates the persistence mechanism itself: a scheduled task configured to execute upon user logon. In a real incident, an unauthorized scheduled task with a suspicious command or executable would warrant further investigation.

7. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	ID	Relevance
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Scheduled Task/Job **T1053** The Windows scheduled task was created and configured with a logon trigger.

Associated Wazuh tactics:

- Execution
- Persistence
- Privilege Escalation

The supplied event directly supports **Scheduled Task/Job (T1053)**. It does not independently demonstrate privilege escalation.

8. Investigation Findings

- Windows Security successfully recorded **Event ID 4698**.
 - Wazuh successfully detected the scheduled task creation with **Rule 60228**.
 - The task name was `\SOC-Lab-persistence-Test`.
 - The task was created under the `WIN11\ vboxuser` user context.
 - The task uses a **logon trigger**.
 - The configured action is `cmd.exe` with a benign echo command.
 - The task is not hidden.
 - The task uses **LeastPrivilege** execution.
 - The evidence demonstrates scheduled-task persistence behavior in the controlled lab.
 - Available evidence does not establish malicious intent or privilege escalation.
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9. Response / Containment

- Validate whether the scheduled task creation was authorized.
 - Review the task definition and command action for suspicious executables, scripts, or external resources.
 - Correlate the task creation timestamp with Windows Security, Sysmon, PowerShell, and Wazuh telemetry.
 - If unauthorized, disable and remove the suspicious scheduled task after preserving relevant evidence.
 - Review other scheduled tasks for similar persistence mechanisms.
 - If unauthorized activity is confirmed, terminate the suspicious session and isolate the endpoint according to incident-response procedures.
 - Preserve the original task definition and associated event records before remediation where feasible.
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10. Evidences

Evidence 1 — Windows Security Event ID 4698

Windows Security recorded the creation of the scheduled task, including the task name, author, trigger, and action.

	Aug 23, 2026 @ 23:44:58.8...	Win-11-SOC	A scheduled task was created	4	-	-	-	-	60228
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Evidence 2 — Scheduled Task Name

\SOC-Lab-persistence-Test

Evidence 3 — Scheduled Task Trigger

LogonTrigger
Enabled = true

Evidence 4 — Scheduled Task Action

cmd.exe /c echo SOC-LAB-PERSISTENCE-TEST

Evidence 5 — Wazuh Detection

Rule ID: 60228
Level: 4
Description: A scheduled task was created

Evidence 6 — MITRE Mapping

T1053 — Scheduled Task/Job

11. Final Assessment

The Home SOC Lab successfully demonstrated a **scheduled-task persistence scenario** following post-RDP activity. Windows Security captured the task creation as **Event ID 4698**, and Wazuh generated **Rule 60228 at Level 4**.

The task was configured to execute a benign command at user logon, providing a controlled demonstration of scheduled-task persistence and successful SIEM detection.

This provides sufficient evidence to document scheduled-task persistence and demonstrates Windows endpoint telemetry, Wazuh alerting, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, and SOC investigation capability.

Based solely on the supplied evidence, the event should not be labeled confirmed malicious.